

UTEW 221 V

SU1_SU2

**What is Philosophy.
Worldviews.**

What is philosophy?

Philosophy is the study of general and fundamental problems concerning matters such as existence, knowledge, values, reason, mind, and language.

Branches of philosophy:

- **Metaphysics** is the study of the nature of being and the world. Traditional branches are cosmology and ontology.
- **Epistemology** is concerned with the nature and scope of knowledge, and whether knowledge is possible
- **Ethics**, or 'moral philosophy', is concerned with questions of how persons ought to act or if such questions are answerable
- **Aesthetics** deals with beauty, art, enjoyment, sensory-emotional values, perception, and matters of taste and sentiment
- **Logic** is the study of valid argument forms.

Who are philosophers?

People who ask simple questions about:

1. The world we live in
2. About our place and role in the world
3. About the universe
4. About humanness

Understand the Philosophies of Education better

Watch the YouTube video below:

- <https://youtu.be/2wYVrPPpzhQ>

Does everybody have a personal philosophy?

- Point of departure for all decisions
- Basic convictions regarding reality and human beings
- Convictions guide and direct your actions
- Religion important, moral implications

Philosophy of South African Education

The Manifesto on Values, Education and Democracy (Department of Education, 2001) identifies ten fundamental values of the Constitution. These are:

- › Democracy
- › Social Justice and Equity
- › Non-Racism and Non-Sexism
- › Ubuntu (Human Dignity)
- › An Open Society
- › Accountability (Responsibility)
- › Respect
- › The Rule of Law
- › Reconciliation

Know yourself as a person

To be able to formulate your own philosophy of life, it is necessary to take stock of your own life:

- How has it progressed up to this point?
- What influence has this particular progress had on you?
- What type of person are you today?
- What type of person and who would you like to be?

Moral responsibility

Most people battle with the question “Towards what/whom is my life directed?” – In other words, what is the focus of my life?

- Some people feel that life should in the first instance be directed towards oneself.
- Other people are of the view that everything that you do must be directed towards others – your fellow humans, and that joy and happiness lie in the fact that you do good onto others – even if it is to the cost of yourself

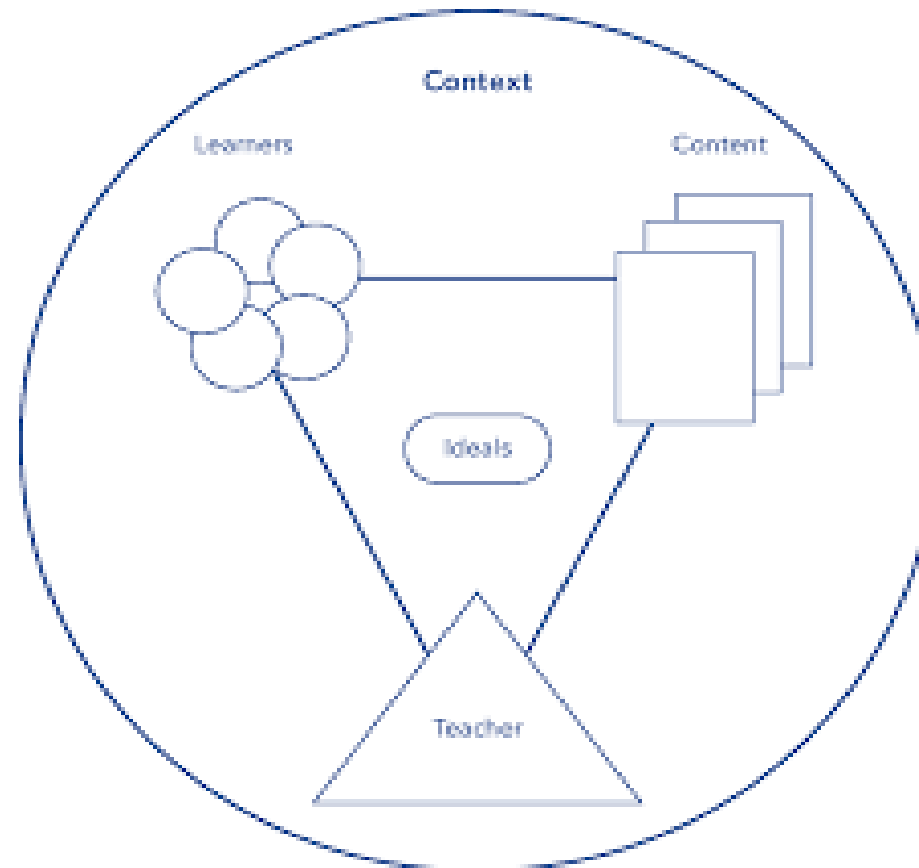
What do I strive towards with my life?

- Most people live from day to day and from year to year.
- Mostly we have a faint idea of what we would want to attain or become.
- Only a few people really contemplate on their future and compile plans and a strategy in order to attain their goals.
- Most of us rather bury our talents and hope for the best instead of thinking thoroughly and realistically about them so as to set goals that we could strive towards.

Prescribed material for this lecture:

(Chapter 1 of Societal Issues: Worldviews: Dealing with conflict through dialogue

1. The educational world



Olthuis: On Worldviews

- Olthuis' task is to look at the anatomy of worldviews, i.e. to ascertain how they are formed, for what purpose, and how they are structured.
- He argues for an integrated, multidimensional model of worldview formation
 - A medium of mediation and integration between commitment in faith and all other human experiences

Worldview characteristics:

- It is comprehensive.
- It is fundamental.
- It is a way in which one looks at things.
- It guides and orientates one in an understanding of reality.
- It forms a unity.
- It is descriptive as well as prescriptive.
- It is an important source for guiding behavior.
- It is something typically human.
- It is prescientific.
- It can elicit strong emotions.
- It normally comes in the form of symbols.

Olthuis: Worldview and framework faith of:

Why Faith?

- “The set of hinges on which all our everyday thinking and doing occurs.”
- Worldview is the ‘truth’ about history, life and existence, and it reveals the way to salvation and healing (how things ought to be in the end)
- Dual focus is descriptive and normative
- Normative = “ought to be” = ultimacy

Olthuis: On Worldviews

- Worldviews are:
- Built upon “matters of ultimate concern”, or rooted in faith
- Has a dual focus: what is and what ought to be
- Framework of faith + life experience

Olthuis: Worldview and framework faith of:

Why Faith?

Therefore:

Because of claims of ultimacy = worldviews find rootedness in faith

- Can be described as “ultimate or grounding dimension or horizon to all meaningful activities.”

Olthuis: Other Modes

Not just Faith

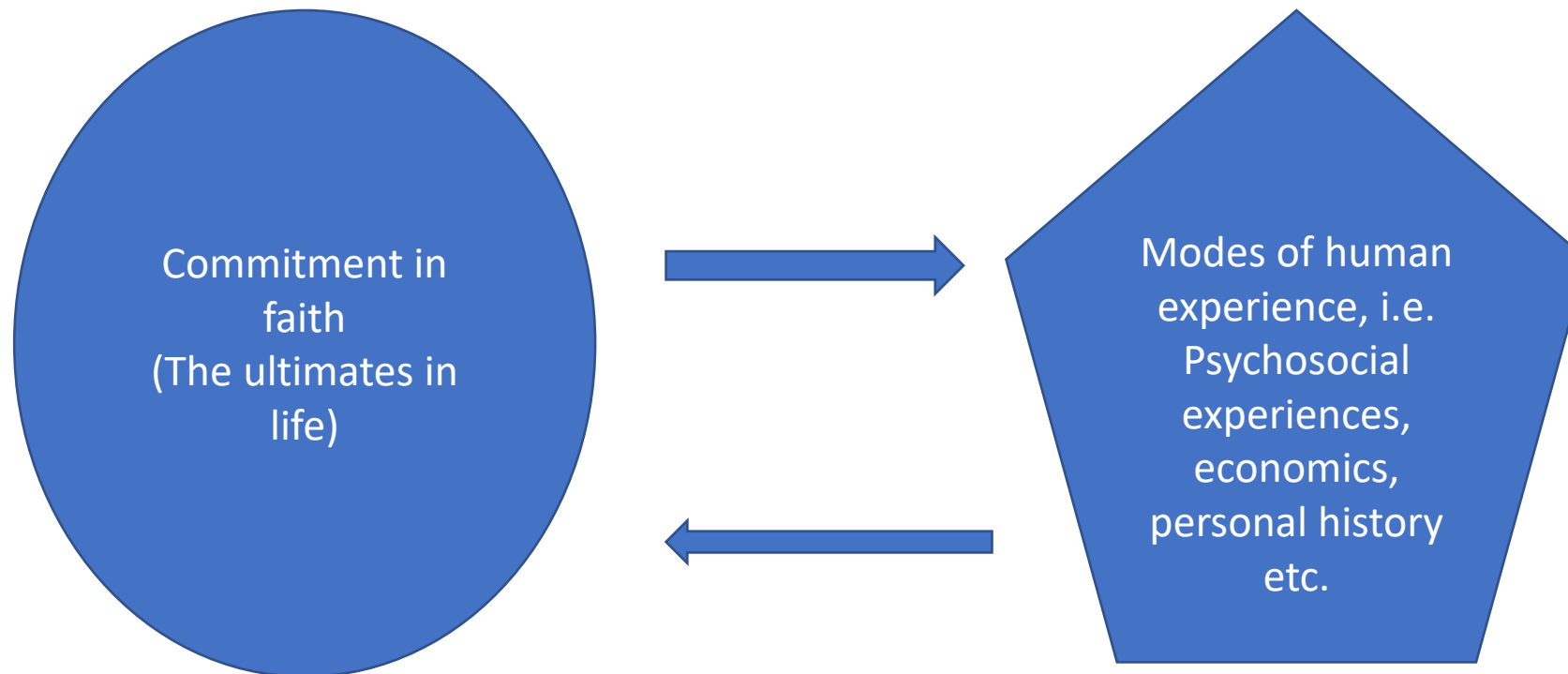
- “WV depend for validation and correction on both the commitment of faith **and all other modes of human experience.**”
- WV shaped by Life Experience
- Both faith for life, and vision of life for faith

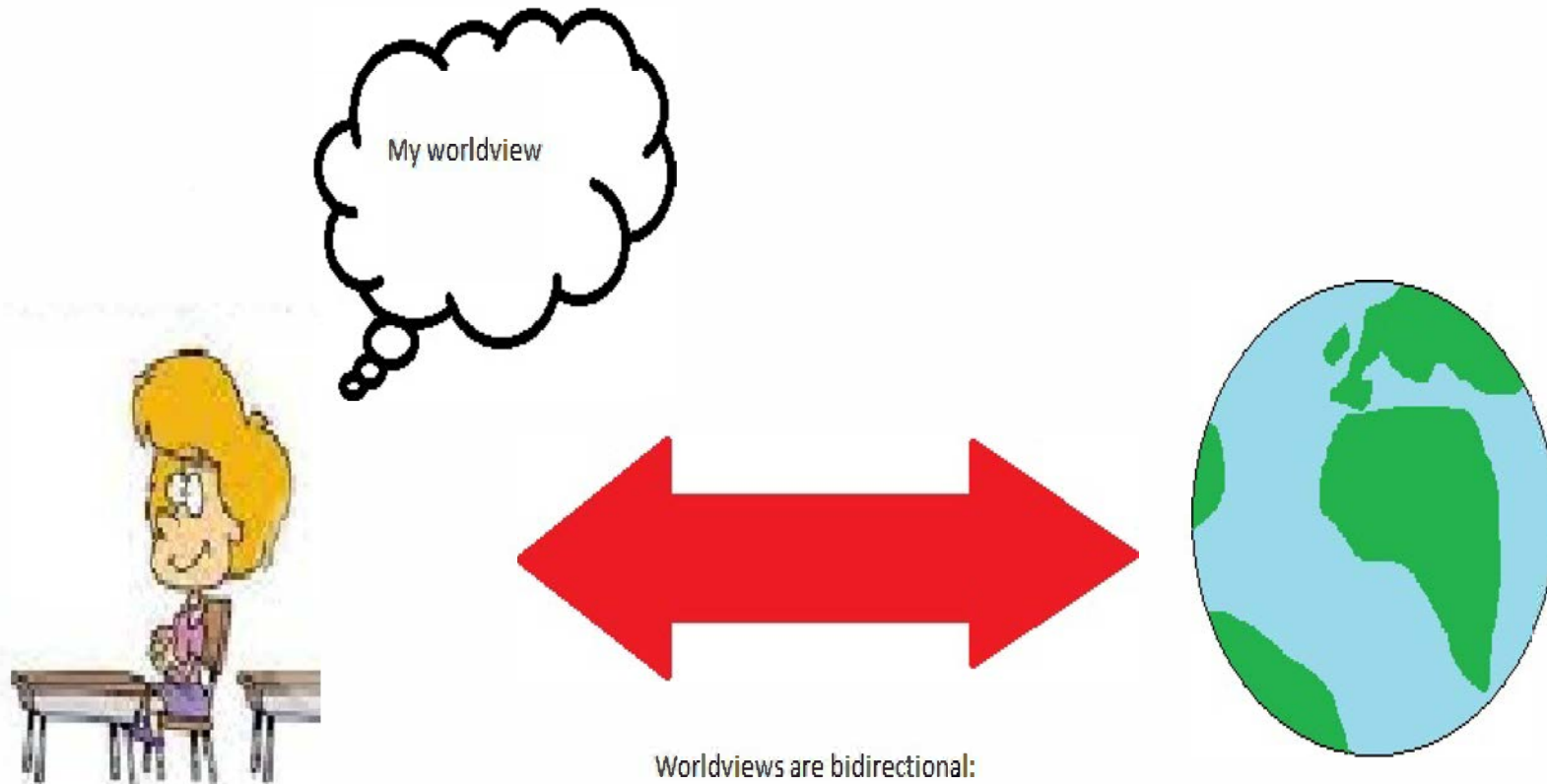
Olthuis: Other Modes

- When life experience and faith integrate, faith deepens and WV strengthens
- When not, crisis occurs
- Unbalanced WV = ideology, anxiety and societal dislocation

Olthuis: Worldview in Process

Worldview





Worldviews are bidirectional:

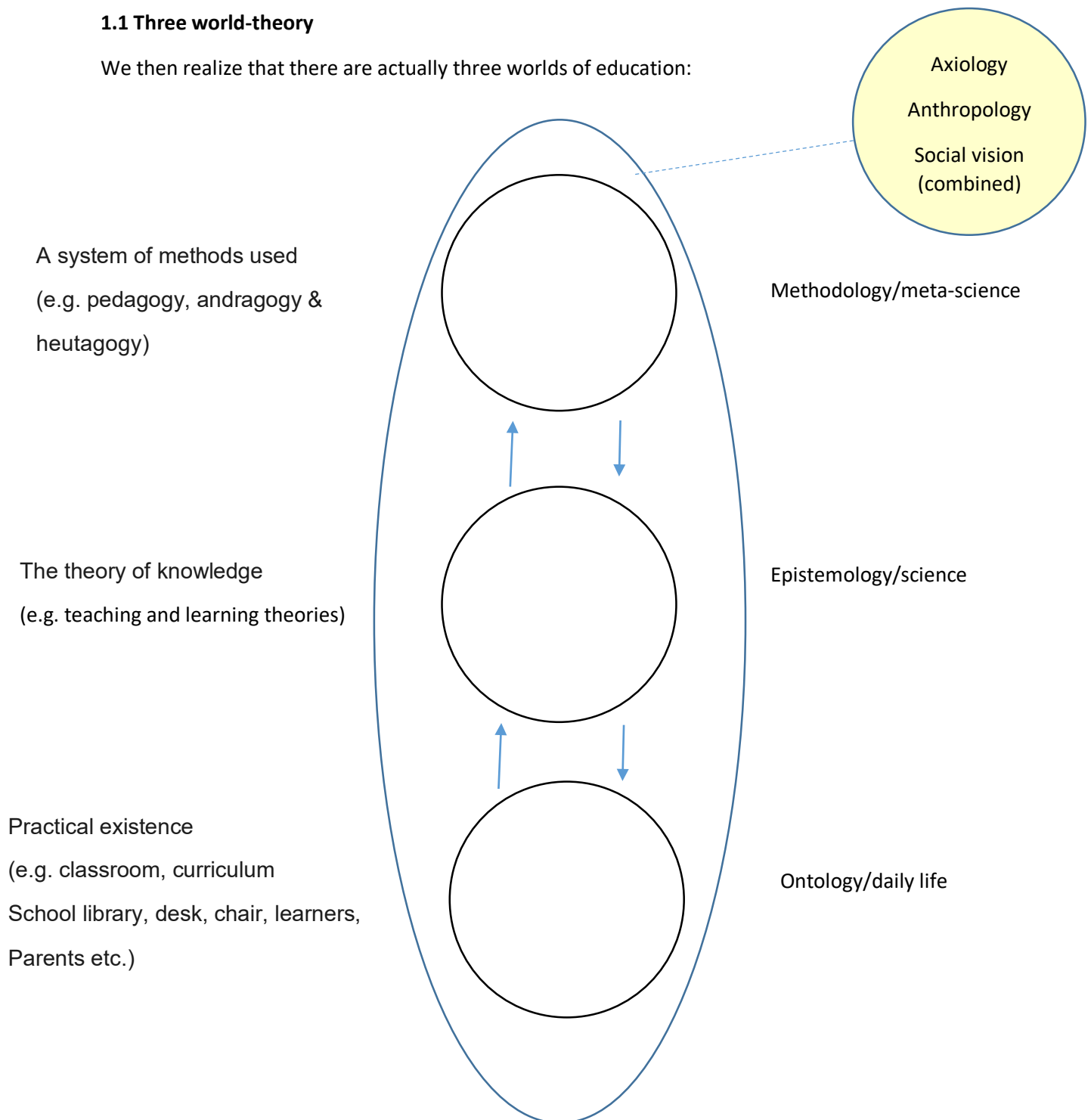
We build our worldview from
experiences in the world,
And we shape our world
according to our worldview.

Olthuis: Worldview in Process

- Worldview to be valid: reality and faith must integrate and mediate.
- Healthy WV change/develops continually
- If WV is absolutized it actually blocks us from truth and being truly open to God's revelation

1.1 Three world-theory

We then realize that there are actually three worlds of education:



1.2.2 Components of worldviews

In the 2nd year UTEW221 we will mainly deal with pre-scientific worldviews, such as those introduced by de Witt et al. (2016:102)³ and [Van Egmond and De Vries \(2016\)](#). Also compare with the worldview components in Chapter 1.



Component	Traditional worldview	Modern worldview	Postmodern worldview	Integrative worldview
Ontology	Religious/metaphysical monism. Reality as singular, transcendent. Universe as purposively constructed whole. God-created universe <i>ex nihilo</i> . Transcendent God/Creator is separate from profane world; dualism. Nature as embodiment of meaningful, imposed order (e.g. God's creation).	Secular materialism. Reality as singular, immanent. Mechanistic universe brought about by random selection. Material reality devoid of meaning, intentionality, consciousness; dualism, disenchantment. Nature as instrumental, devoid of intrinsic meaning and purpose. Resource for exploitation.	Post-materialism. Reality as pluralistic, perspectival, constructed. Multiple cosmogonies/cosmogony as social construct. Reality as discontinuous and fragmented, meaning as social construct; anti-essentialism. Nature as constructed through a plurality of cultural values, meanings, and interests.	Holism/integralism (unity in diversity). Reality as transcendent <i>and</i> immanent. Universe as evolving, creative manifestation of Source/Spirit. Outer and inner reality co-arising, interdependent; re-enchantment. Nature as intrinsically valuable. Frequently seen as divine force that humanity is part and expression of.
Epistemology	Naïve realism; emphasis on concrete-literal interpretations of religious doctrine (literalism, dogmatism). Religious/conventional authority (scripture, divine revelation, tradition). Implicit methodology. Substantive rationality.	(Post-)positivism; emphasis on reality as objectively knowable, (empiricism, reductionism, scientism). Secular authority (science, the state). Quantitative methods; methodological monism. Procedural rationality.	Social constructivism; emphasis on reality as constructed (pluralism, relativism). Internalization of authority (e.g. moral, emotional, intuitive, artistic knowing). Qualitative methods; methodological pluralism. Skeptical rationality?	Critical realism, pragmatism; emphasis on reality as approachable through integration of sources of knowledge. Triangulation of authority (scientific, spiritual/religious/philosophical, and subjective knowing). Mixed methods; integrative pluralism. Synthetic rationality?
Axiology	Traditional values (e.g. security, tradition, conformity, obedience, humility). Emphasis on community, family. Pre-conventional morality?	Rational-secular, materialist values (e.g. power, achievement, hedonism, stimulation). Emphasis on independent individuality. Conventional morality?	Self-expression, post-materialist values (e.g. openness to change, self-direction). Emphasis on unique individuality. Postconventional morality?	Self-expression/self-transcendence values (e.g. universalism, self-actualization)? Emphasis on embedded, relational individuality. Universal morality?
Anthropology	Humanity in managerial stewardship role vis-à-vis nature. Prime purposes determined by larger order and social roles. Human being as sinful/fallen from grace. Dependent on religious/metaphysical authorities for salvation. Ethnocentric identity?	Humanity in promethean control over nature. Prime purposes of a material, hedonistic nature. Human being as self-optimizing, independent being. <i>Homo economicus</i> . Sociocentric identity?	Humanity in cautious relationship to nature. Prime purposes are found within, intrinsic. Human being as self-expressing, unique individual. Worldcentric identity?	Humanity in unity and synergy with nature. Prime purposes found within, serving the larger whole ('service through self-actualization'). Human being as evolutionary co-creator, with a vast—though generally unrealized—potential. Planetcentric identity?
Societal vision	Traditional societies, emphasis on (subsistence) farming. Traditional and religious authorities and values as source of solutions to societal and environmental problems.	Industrial societies, emphasis on mechanized modes of production (e.g. industrial/conventional agriculture). Technological optimism: science and technology as solutions to societal and environmental problems.	Post-industrial societies, emphasis on service economy and creative industries. Scepticism of status quo, idealism: mobilization of the public through revealing injustices as prime solution to societal and environmental problems.	Increasing emphasis on services, creative industries, and social/sustainable entrepreneurship. Integrative vision: emancipation of the public through consciousness growth and a synthesis of interests and perspectives as solutions to societal and environmental problems.

³ [De Witt et al. \(2016\)](#)

1.2.3 The worldview test

To help you determine your own dominant and opposing worldviews, take the online worldview test here: <https://wvtest.com/responses/5b9vx2/intro>

You will need to provide your email address to receive feedback on your worldview. The feedback will give you a summary of each of the worldviews. Use this feedback along with the information on page 14 of the textbook to complete the table below.

Worldview component	Traditionalism	Modernism	Post-modernism	Integrative
God				
Norms				
Individual				
Society				
Nature				
Time				

1.3 Self-study activity 1 - for preparation towards the assignment

Prepare an introductory paragraph of about 100-150 words for your academic essay. Your paragraph should introduce the reader to a problem/issue in the educational world. Refer to the chapters in the textbook on what educational issues exist. Furthermore, your introduction should identify the dominant and opposing worldviews as indicated by the report you obtained from taking the online worldview test. You should also include a brief statement about the underlying worldview component that seems to be at the root of the issue and propose briefly a possible solution to overcome this issue.

⁴ [Erstad & Voogt \(2017\)](#)

[illegible]